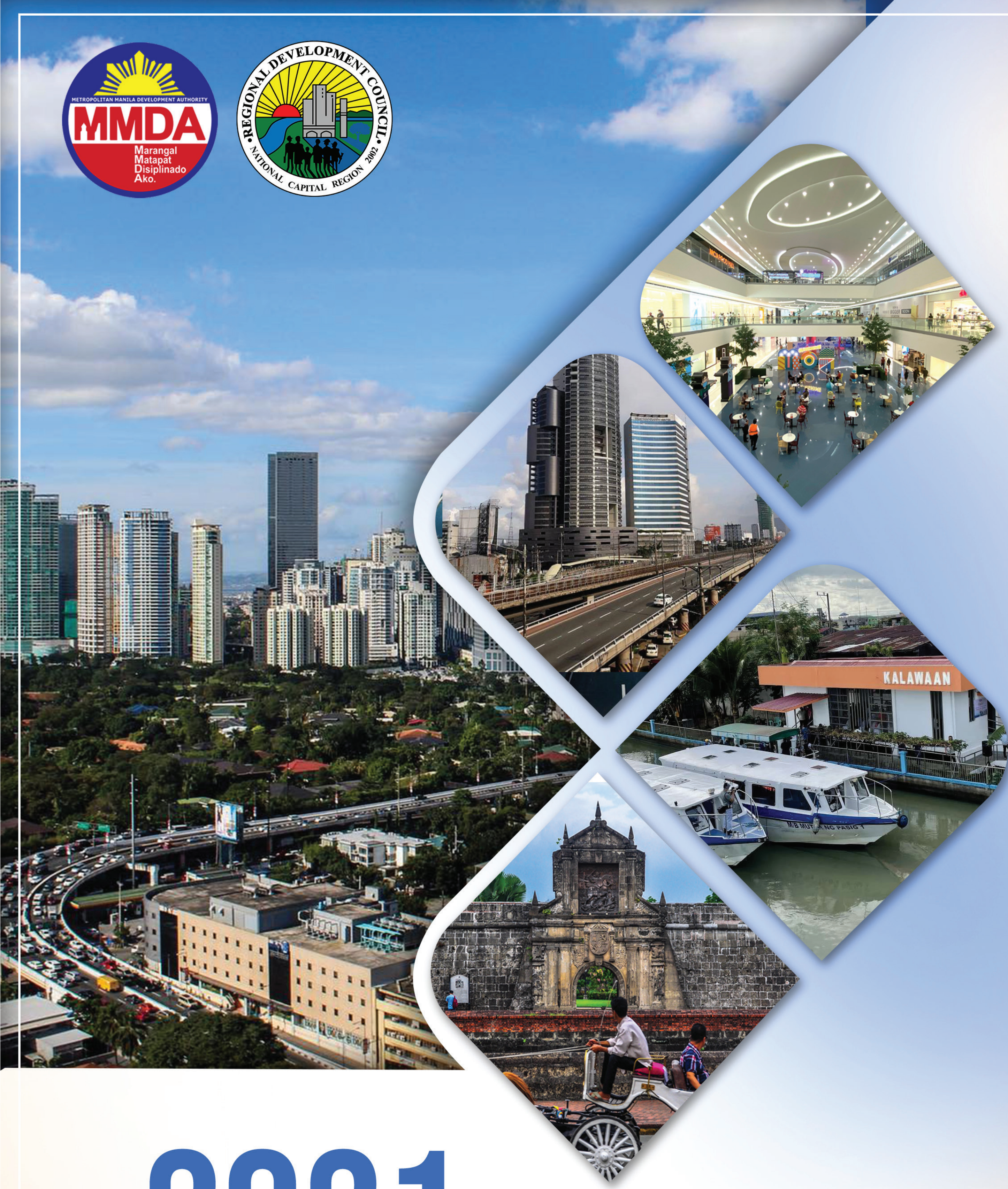


2021

Regional Economic Situationer

National Capital Region

Table of Contents

List of Tables

List of Figures

List of Data Providers

Philippine Statistics Authority - National Capital Region

- Population and Density
- Poverty Statistics (poverty threshold, poverty incidence, food threshold, and subsistence incidence)
- Average Annual Family Income and Expenditure
- Gross Regional Domestic Product
- Gross Value Added of Industry and Services Sector
- Growth Rates of GRDP
- Inflation
- Labor Statistics (employment, unemployment, and underemployment)
- Investments
- Business Establishments and its contribution to employment
- Operational and Non-Operational Business Establishments

Department of Tourism - National Capital Region

- Visitors Arrival (same-day visitors and overnight visitors)

01

Demographic Profile of the National Capital Region

Population and Density

The National Capital Region (NCR) reported a total population of 13,484,462 – registering as the 2nd most populous region in the latest 2020 Census of Population and Housing (2020 CPH). The region accounts for 12.37% of the 109,033,245 total population from the 17 administrative regions. This registered a 0.97 percent growth from 2015, ranking as the third region with the slowest population growth compared to BARMM (3.26%), CALABARZON (2.48%), and Region III (2.17%).

The cities with the highest population recorded are Quezon City, City of Caloocan, and the City of Manila. These are also the cities with more than a million inhabitants and comprise 47.0 percent of the region's total population. Moreover, the NCR is extremely dense, having a population density of 21,765 persons per square kilometer, compared to the national figure of 363 persons per square kilometer. The City of Manila, City of Mandaluyong, and Pasay City registered as the most densely populated cities in the region.

Table 1. Population and Population Density of the NCR

LOCAL GOVERNMENT UNIT	POPULATION (2020)	POPULATION GROWTH (%)	LAND AREA (square kilometers)	POPULATION DENSITY (persons per square kilometer)
NATIONAL CAPITAL REGION (NCR)	**13,484,462**	**0.97**	**619.54**	**21,765**
City of Manila	1,846,513	0.77	24.98	73,920
City of Mandaluyong	425,758	2.07	9.29	45,830
City of Marikina	456,059	0.25	21.52	21,192
City of Pasig	803,159	1.30	48. 46	16,574
Quezon City	2,960,048	0.17	171.71	17,239
City of San Juan	126,347	0.71	5.95	21,235
City of Caloocan	1,661,584	1.01	55.8	29,777
City of Malabon	380,522	0.85	15.71	24,222
City of Navotas	247,543	-0.16	8.94	27,689
City of Valenzuela	714,978	3.03	47.02	15,206
City of Las Piñas	606,293	0.61	32.69	18,547
City of Makati	629,616	1.65	21.57	29,189
City of Muntinlupa	543,445	1.58	39.75	13,672
City of Parañaque	689,992	0.75	46.57	14,816
Pasay City	440,656	1.19	13.97	31,543
City of Taguig	886,722	2.06	45.21	19,613
Pateros	65,227	0.45	10.4	6,272

Source: 2020 Census of Population and Housing (2020 CPH)
Philippine Statistics Authority (PSA)

Poverty

NCR recorded the lowest poverty incidence among population in the country in 2021 with 3.5 percent, representing a total of 482,483 individuals living below the regional annual per capita poverty threshold of PHP 32,978.00. This is higher than the 2.2 percent or 302,166 population reported in 2018 who live under the identified annual poverty threshold of PHP 28,682.00. The increase may be attributed to the ongoing health crisis that disrupted the economic activities in all cities and municipality in the region, resulting in the loss of income for some families. Moreover, the City of Taguig (6.5%), City of Caloocan (6.0%), and City of Navotas (5.1%) registered the highest poverty incidence in Metro Manila.

Likewise, a slight increase in the subsistence incidence among population in the region was also observed in 2021, recording 0.5 percent or 63,559 individuals who live below the annual per capita food threshold of PHP 23,028.00. Despite the region posting a low subsistence incidence, Pasay City (1.2%), City of Navotas (0.9%), and City of Pasig (0.8%) top the list among the 17 Local Government Units in the NCR.

Table 2. Poverty Incidence and Subsistence Incidence in Metro Manila, 2018 and 2021

POVERTY AND SUBSISTENCE INCIDENCE	2018	2021
Poverty Incidence		
Annual per Capita Poverty Threshold (PHP)	28,682.00	32,978.00
Poverty Incidence among Families (%)	1.4	2.2
Number of Poor Families	47,588	76,157
Poverty Incidence among Population (%)	2.2	3.5
Number of Poor Population	302,166	482,483
Subsistence Incidence		
Annual per Capita Food Threshold (PHP)	20,029.00	23,028.00
Subsistence Incidence among Families (%)	0.2	0.3
Number of Subsistence Poor Families	8,073	9,089
Subsistence Incidence among Population (%)	0.4	0.5
Number of Subsistence Poor Population	54,078	63,559

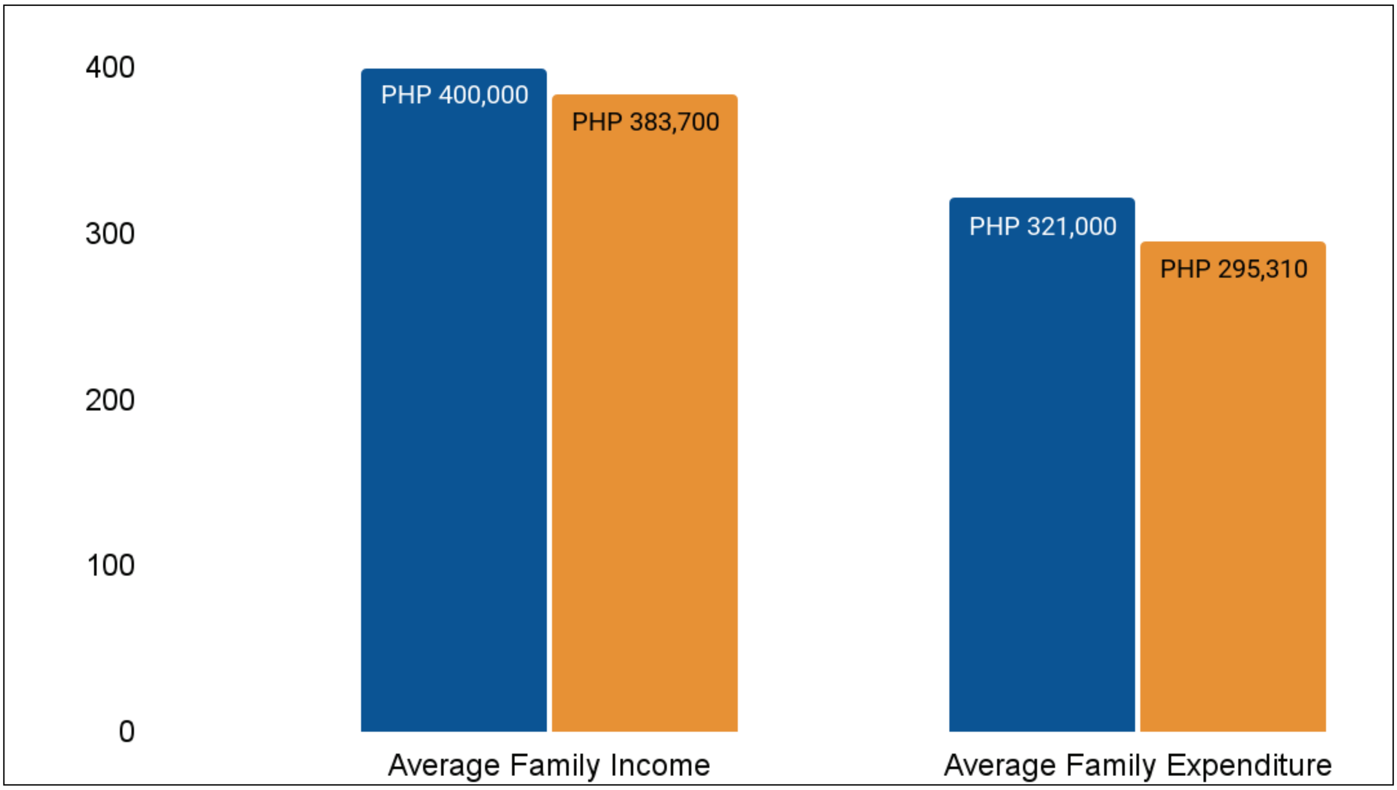
Source: 2021 Full Year Official Poverty Statistics
Philippine Statistics Authority (PSA)

Family Income and Expenditure

In 2021, NCR recorded an average annual family income of PHP 383,700.00, with the City of Makati, City of San Juan, and City of Marikina posting the highest average earnings of families within the region. This is lower than the PHP 400,000.00 average family earnings that was reported in 2018, representing a 4.1 percent decline. This may be attributed to the discharge of employees in some businesses as they face negative returns in their revenues due to the pandemic, resulting in unemployment and loss of source of income to some families.

Likewise, the annual average expenditure of families in the region also declined to PHP 295,300.00 from the PHP 321,000.00 reported in 2018, representing an 8.0 percent reduction in the average family expenditure. The effects of the pandemic on the employment status in the region, as well as on the daily life of the consumers may have contributed to the shift in their expenditure pattern while taking into consideration the high level of uncertainties in the economy's recovery.

Figure 1. Average Annual Family Income and Expenditure in NCR, 2018 and 2021



Source: Family Income and Expenditure Survey
Philippine Statistics Authority (PSA)

02

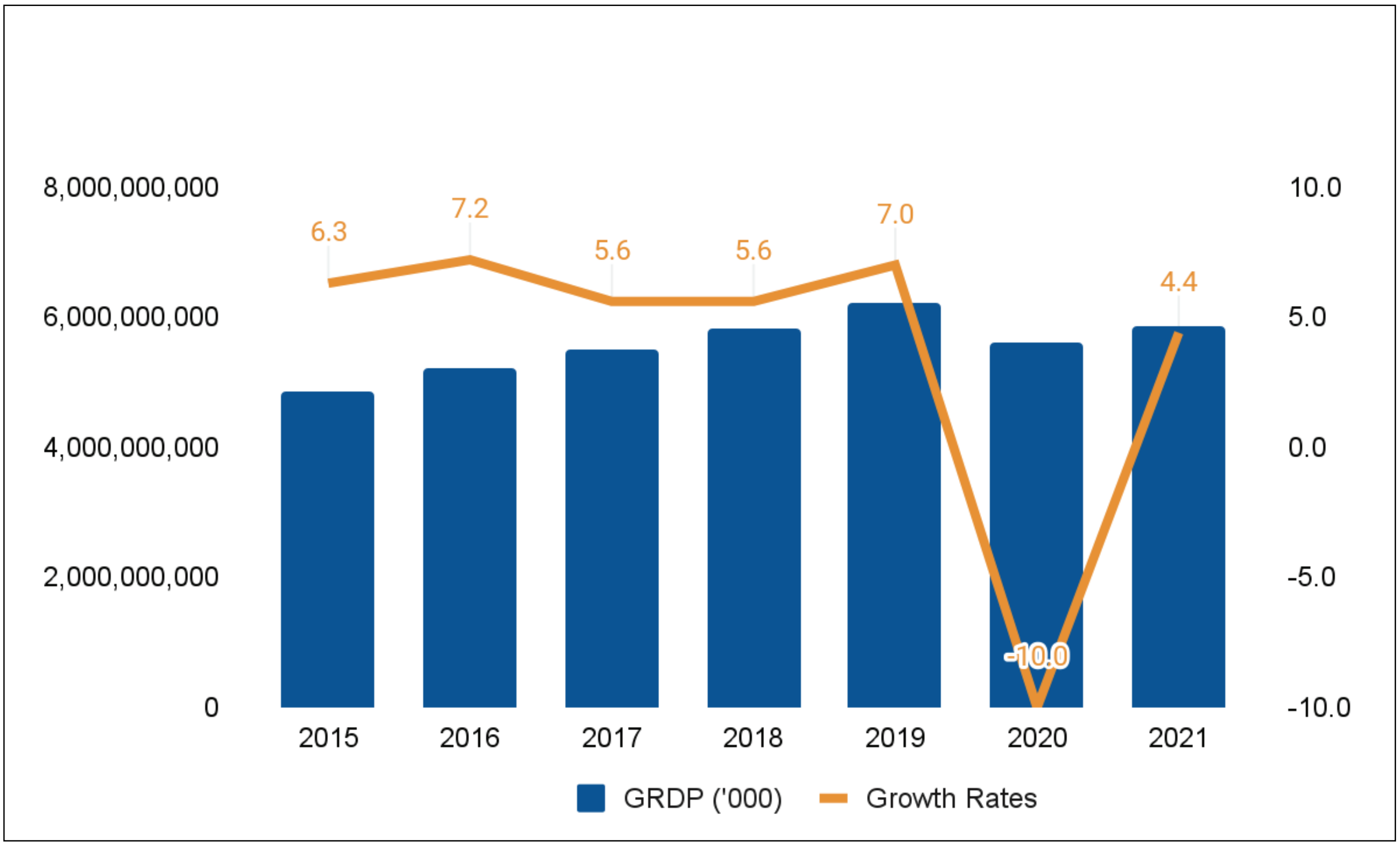
Economic Profile of the National Capital Region

Gross Regional Domestic Product

NCR recovered from the contraction of its economy in 2020 caused by the pandemic through interventions, programs, projects, and policies implemented by the local government units (LGUs), Regional Line Agencies (RLAs), and private stakeholders. This aligns with the region's goal to revitalize and bring its economy back to its glory.

In 2021, the region recorded a 4.4 percent economic growth rate of PHP 5.8 trillion Gross Regional Domestic Product (GRDP), making the region the highest contributor to the national Gross Domestic Product (GDP). This growth is attributed to the less restricted economic activities imposed in the region by lifting mobility restrictions, allowing businesses to operate with more workers, ensuring clean and safe destinations and accommodations to boost domestic travel, enhancing the production of goods and services, and improving domestic consumption.

Figure 2. Levels and Growth Rates of Gross Regional Domestic Product of NCR, 2015-2021



Source: Regional Accounts of the Philippines (Philippine Statistics Authority)

Moreover, the GRDP of the NCR is mainly contributed by the Services and Industry Sectors which are the main economic drivers of Metro Manila. These sectors posted positive growth rates, contributing to the overall economic performance of the region. However, despite being the highest contributor to the economy of the country, the NCR still lags behind other regions in terms of economic growth and has not reached its pre-pandemic level. This calls for more effective programs, projects, and policies to boost its economy and encourage more investments in the region.

Services Sector

The Services Sector has the highest contribution to the economic outputs and activities, which recorded an 81.4 percent share to its GRDP in 2021. The top performing services industries are the wholesale and retail trade; repair of motor vehicles and motorcycles with 23.0 percent share in the GRDP, followed by the financial and insurance activities (19.3%), and professional and business services (12.6%).

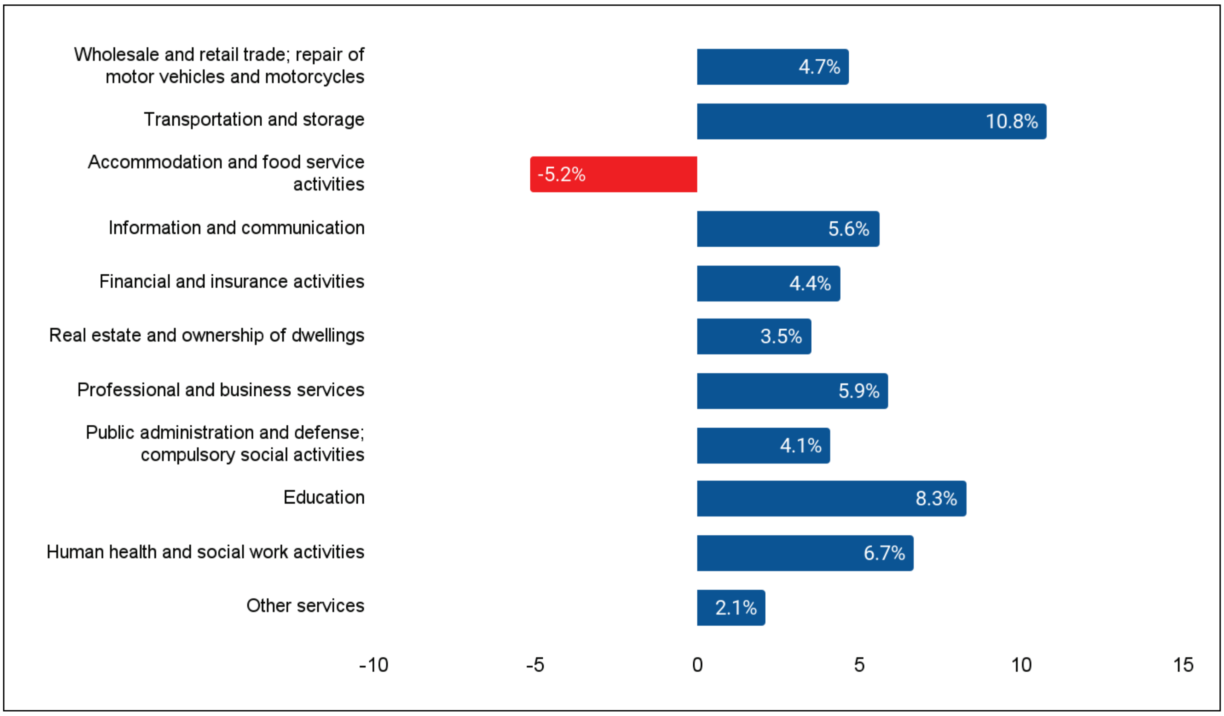
Table 3. Share of Services Sector by Industry in NCR, 2021

INDUSTRY	GROSS VALUE ADDED ('OOO)	PERCENT SHARE TO THE GRDP (%)
Services Sector	**4,755,589,112**	**81.4**
Wholesale and retail trade; repair of motor vehicles and motorcycles	1,342,101,433	23.0
Transportation and storage	117,868,362	2.0
Accommodation and food service activities	51,491,155	0.9
Information and communication	152,294,356	2.6
Financial and insurance activities	1,125,630,489	19.3
Real estate and ownership of dwellings	363,630, 409	6.2
Professional and business services	733,749,587	12.6
Public administration and defense; compulsory social activities	548,599,005	9.4
Education	115,585,619	2.0
Human health and social work activities	112,558,100	1.9
Other services	92,080,598	1.6

Source: Regional Accounts of the Philippines (Philippine Statistics Authority)

Moreover, the sector registered a significant growth of 4.8 percent from the 9.1 percent contraction in the previous year, contributing a total of PHP 4.75 trillion to the overall output of the NCR. These improvements in the sector were observed in the transport and storage industry which posted the highest growth rate of 10.8 percent as the region started opening its boundaries to the other areas and permitting all public transport vehicles to operate in and out of Metro Manila. It was followed by the education industry with 8.3 percent growth which may be attributed to the implementation of modular and remote learning in private and public schools, Higher Education Institutions (HEIs), and State Universities and Colleges (SUCs). The high demand for health services and social work due to the impact of the pandemic had also resulted in the 6.7 percent growth in the human health and social work industry.

Figure 3. Growth Rates in the Services Sector by Industry, 2020-2021



Source: Regional Accounts of the Philippines (Philippine Statistics Authority)

Most of the industries under the Services Sector have bounced back from the negative effects of the pandemic and posted a positive growth rate. However, the accommodation and food service industry still faces a challenge as it registered a -5.2 percent growth in 2021 from the 52.0 percent contraction in the previous year. The strict health guidelines and protocols implemented in accommodation and food establishments, longer required quarantine periods for domestic and international tourists to prevent the spread of the virus, and the lower confidence to travel are some of the factors that remain a concern for the industry.

Industry Sector

The Industry Sector recovered from the 13.6 percent contraction in the previous year and recorded a 2.6 percent growth in 2021 as the result of the improvements and development in all the industries under the sector, specifically, in the mining and quarrying, construction, and manufacturing industries. This represents a total of PHP 1.08 trillion or an 18.6 percent share of the sector to the total GRDP of the NCR in 2021.

Table 4. Share of Industry Sector by Industry in NCR, 2021

INDUSTRY	GROSS VALUE ADDED ('OOO)	PERCENT SHARE TO THE GRDP (%)
Industry Sector	**1,089,276,483**	**18.6**
Mining and quarrying	422,382	0.01
Manufacturing	761,743,066	13.0
Electricity, steam, water and waste management	88,373,905	1.5
Construction	238,737,130	4.1

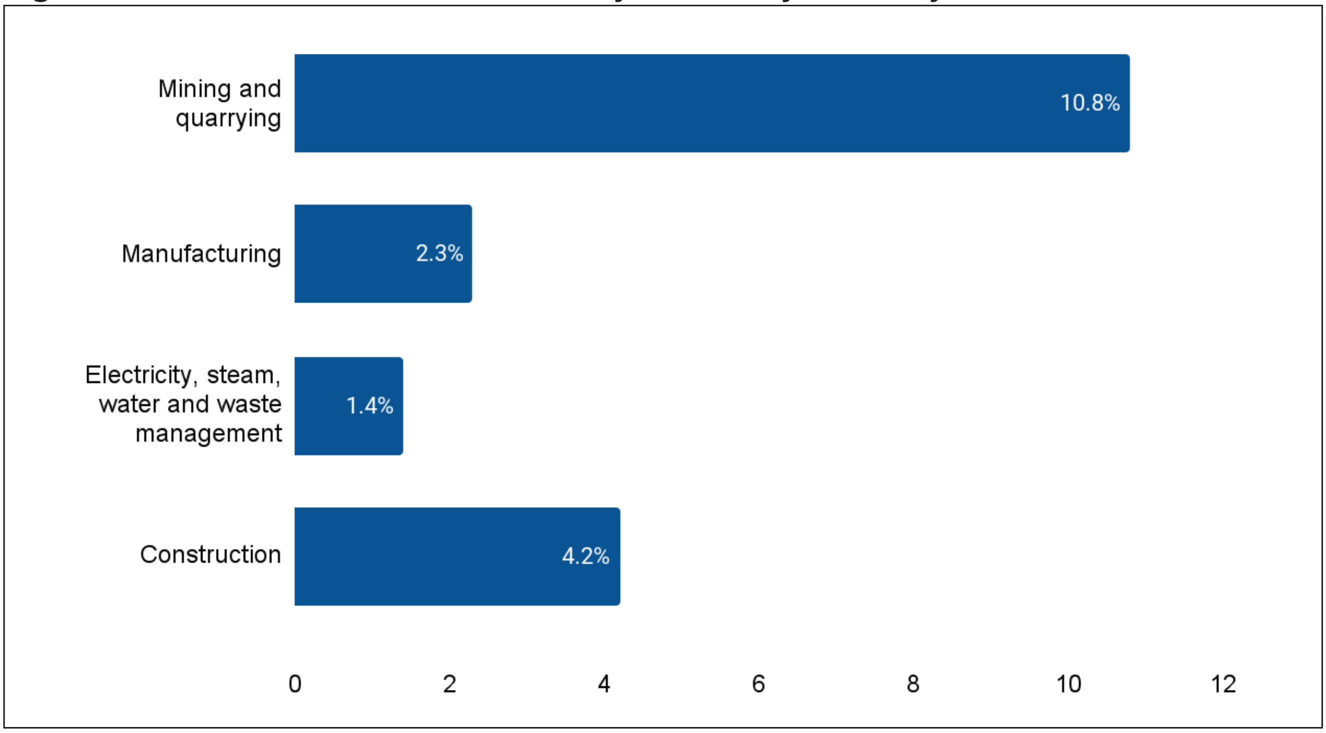
Source: Regional Accounts of the Philippines (Philippine Statistics Authority)

The easing of community quarantines and mobility restrictions in the country contributed to the growth in the mining and quarrying industry with 10.8 percent, which is the highest growth among the other industries in the sector. It allows the mining companies located in the NCR to continue their operations and to rebound from the loss in their revenues incurred during the surge of COVID-19 in 2020.

Likewise, an increase in the construction industry's performance is observed, registering a 4.2 percent growth from the previous year. Construction companies were able to attract new projects through the Build, Build, Build Program of the government, and the flow of the supply chain for the raw materials used in their operations returned to normal.

Moreover, a 2.3 percent growth in the manufacturing industry was registered as manufacturing companies were permitted to operate with more workers, hence, increasing their production and sales.

Figure 4. Growth Rates in the Industry Sector by Industry, 2020-2021



Source: Regional Accounts of the Philippines (Philippine Statistics Authority)

Inflation

NCR showed a shift in the needs and preferences of its consumers in the region in 2021 due to the pandemic, affecting the trend of the inflation rate for some of the available commodities and services. Among these commodities, financial services, alcoholic beverages and tobacco, and transport posted the highest inflation rates in the NCR. On average, the region recorded a 2.7 inflation rate for all the commodity items.

The financial services registered the highest inflation rate with 34.5 percent which may be attributed to the high interest rates in loans and credits provided by some credit sources as economic uncertainties remained a challenge in 2021. Some of these sources include microfinance non-government organizations (MF NGOs), government institutions, cooperatives, lending/financing institutions, banks, and pawnshops.

Meanwhile, the 8.4 percent change in the prices of alcoholic beverages and tobacco is due to the law implemented by the government that imposed higher taxes on these products in the country.

The increase in the prices of crude oil in the local and international markets also resulted in higher transportation fares, and the limited capacity of public transport vehicles to ensure the safety of the commuters further put pressure on the transport industry, causing the change in its prices.

Table 5. Inflation Rates in NCR, 2020-2021

COMMODITIES	2020	2021
ALL ITEMS	**2.2**	**2.7**
Food and Non-Alcoholic Beverages	3.2	3.4
Alcoholic Beverages and Tobacco	12.2	8.4
Clothing and Footwear	1.1	0.8
Housing, Water, Electricity, Gas and Other Fuels	-0.4	1.9
Furnishings, Household Equipment and Routine Household Maintenance	5.1	1.2
Health	2.6	2.2
Transport	5.5	6.3
Information and Communication	0.2	0.3
Recreation, Sport and Culture	0.4	-0.4
Education Services	2.6	0.2
Restaurants and Accommodation Services	1.8	2.2
Financial Services	-	34.5
Personal Care, and Miscellaneous Goods and Services	-	1.6

Source: Regional Accounts of the Philippines (Philippine Statistics Authority)

Employment

There is an optimistic outlook in the labor market in the region as the NCR adapts to the new normal and strives to attain economic recovery. More jobs were created and more workers engaged in the economic activities of the region as the results of the implementation of new policies and programs which allowed various industries to expand and continue their operations with fewer restrictions.

In 2021, the NCR recorded an improvement in the labor force participation rate, registering 60.6 percent or a total number of 6,145,446 individuals who were involved in the labor market. It is higher than the 56.7 percent registered in the previous year during the surge of COVID-19. Moreover, the employment rate in the region recorded an increase with 90.7 percent, representing 5,573,920 workers in the region. The launching of virtual job fairs by the government agencies and the health guidelines imposed to ensure the safety of the workers in their workplaces may have contributed to restore the confidence of employees in regard to their safety against the virus.

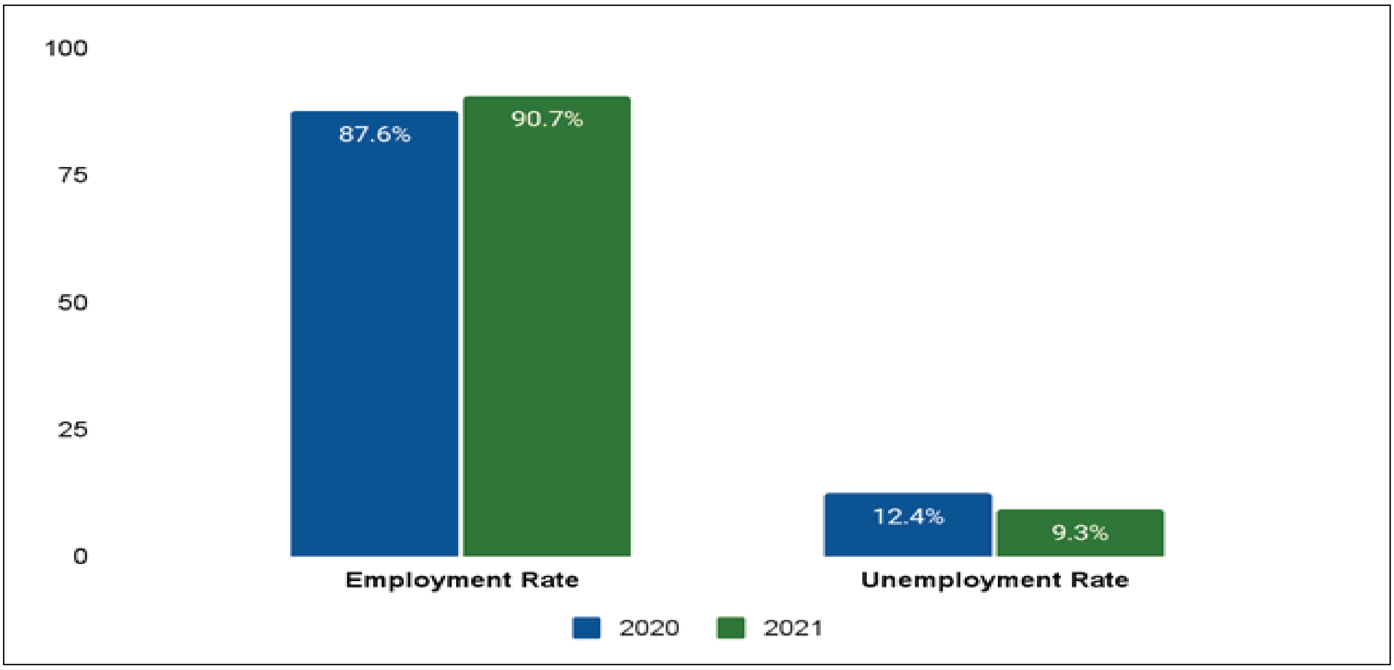
Meanwhile, the unemployment rate decreased to 9.3 percent or 571,526 workers from the 12.4 percent in 2020 as the region aimed to further open its economy and boost its activities.

Table 6. Labor Force Participation, Employment, Unemployment, and Underemployment Rates in NCR, 2020-2021

LABOR FORCE INDICATORS IN NCR	2020	2021
Household Population 15 years and older	10,027,000	10,141,000
Labor Force Participation		
Labor Force Participation Rate (%)	56.7%	60.6%
Total Number of Labor Force Participation	5,685,309	6,145,446
Employment		
Employment Rate (%)	87.6%	90.7%
Total Number of Employed	4,980,331	5,573,920
Unemployment		
Unemployment Rate (%)	12.4%	9.3%
Total Number of Unemployed	704,978	571,526
Underemployment		
Underemployment Rate (%)	11.1%	10.2%
Total Number of Underemployed	552,817	568,540

Source: Philippine Statistics Authority (PSA)
Note: Details may not sum up due to rounding.

Figure 5. Employment and Unemployment Rates of the NCR, 2020-2021



Source: Philippine Statistics Authority (PSA)
Note: Details may not sum up due to rounding.

Investments

In 2021, the NCR recorded a 42.5 percent decline in the total approved Foreign and Filipino nationals investments from 2020. The region registered a total of PHP 94,845,100,000 approved investments, which is relatively lower than the PHP 164,999,800,000 investments from the previous year.

The foreign investments registered the highest contraction in 2021 with 85.0 percent, recording only PHP 6,051,100,000. Likewise, Filipino nationals' investments contracted by 28.7 percent with PHP 88,794,000,000. This decreasing trend may be attributed to the prolonged impositions of community quarantines and the high number of COVID-19 cases in the NCR, resulting in uncertainties in the economic recovery of the business sector, higher risks, and reduced confidence to invest in the region.

Table 7. Approved Foreign and Filipino Nationals Investments in the NCR, 2020-2021

INVESTORS	2020	2021	PERCENT CHANGE (%)
Foreign Investments (in million pesos)	40,380.30	6,051.10	-85.0%
Filipino National Investments (in million pesos)	124,619.50	88,794.00	-28.7%
Total Investments (in million pesos)	**164,999.80**	**94,845.10**	**-42.5%**

Source: Philippine Statistics Authority (PSA)

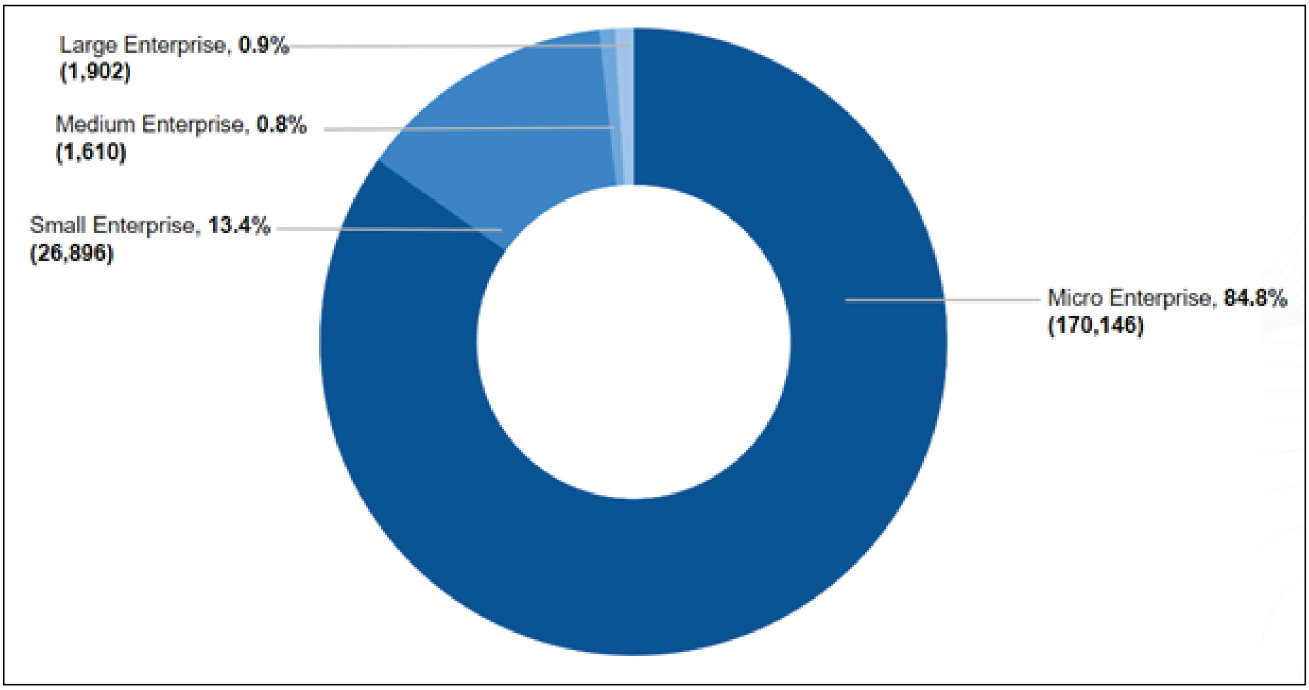
Nevertheless, despite the decline in investments, the NCR still remains one of the highest contributors to the overall investments in the country, ranking as the third region with the highest share in the total national investments next to CALABARZON and Central Luzon.

Business Establishments

In 2021, NCR was recorded as the highest contributor to the total number of establishments operating in the country with 200,554 enterprises. It is 1.7 percent lower than the reported establishments in 2019, which may be attributed to the impact of the pandemic on the business sector of the region. The recurring travel bans and mobility restrictions resulted in the permanent closure of some of the businesses as their operating costs exceeded their generated revenues, and it continues to pressure the business operations in the region.

These business establishments comprise of micro, small, medium, and large enterprises with micro establishments contributing the highest percentage share of 84.8 percent, followed by small enterprises (13.4%), medium enterprises (0.8%), and large business establishments (0.9%).

Figure 6. Business Establishments in NCR, 2021



Source: 2022 Regional Social Economic Trends (RSET)
Philippine Statistics Authority

In addition, the business establishments in the NCR registered a total of 2,769,312 employees, representing a 10.5 percent decline from the 3,094,419 workers reported in 2019. This may be attributed to some factors such as the closure of some business establishments, restricted number of workers allowed to work in a business operation, and the limited capacity of the enterprises to hire more workers due to the high risk of expanding operations at times of economic uncertainties.

Among the sectors in the NCR, the enterprises under the Services Sector has the highest contribution to the overall employment generated by business establishments with 2,342,766 employees or 84.6 percent share, followed by the Industry Sector with 416,995 or 15.1 percent share, and Agriculture, Forestry, and Fishing (AFF) with 9,551 generated employment or 0.3 percent share.

Table 8. Contribution to Employment of Business Establishments in NCR, 2021

BUSINESS ESTABLISHMENTS BY INDUSTRY	2021
Total Contribution to Employment	**2,769,312**
Agriculture, Forestry, and Fishing (AFF)	9,551
Industry	416,995
Mining and Quarrying	4,732
Manufacturing	255,095
Electricity, gas, steam and air-conditioning supply	9,027
Water supply, sewerage, waste management and remediation activities	5,236
Construction	142,905
Services	2,342,766

BUSINESS ESTABLISHMENTS BY INDUSTRY	2021
Wholesale and retail trade; repair of motor vehicles and motorcycles	593,857
Transportation and Storage	143,386
Accommodation and food service activities	184,953
Information and Communication	135,372
Financial and insurance activities	181,720
Real estate activities	66,255
Professional, scientific and technical services	98,739
Administrative and support service activities	707,179
Education	69,853
Human health and social work activities	75,315
Arts, entertainment and recreation	19,753
Other service activities	66,384

Source: 2022 Regional Social Economic Trends (RSET)
Philippine Statistics Authority

However, NCR also recorded the highest number of permanently closed establishments in 2021, registering 5,370 enterprises or 38.0 percent of the 14,144 closed business establishments in the country. The cities with the highest number of non-operation enterprises are the City of Valenzuela, City of Malabon, and Quezon City.

Moreover, a total of 25,410 employees were affected by the closure of these establishments, mainly from the City of Valenzuela, Quezon City, and City of Makati.

Table 9. Operational and Non-Operational Business Establishments in the NCR, 2021

ESTABLISHMENTS	2021
Business Establishments	
Number of Establishments	200,554
Contribution to Employment	2,769,312
Non-Operational	
Number of Establishments	5,370
Contribution to Employment	25,410

Source: 2022 Regional Social Economic Trends (RSET)
2021 Updated List of Establishments
Philippine Statistics Authority

Tourism

NCR garnered a total of 2,419,415 same-day visitors and 2,201,903 overnight visitors in 2021, which consist of foreign, local, and overseas visitors who visited and stayed in some cities in the region. This is relatively higher than the 716,350 same-day visitors and 1,637,815 overnight visitors that were reported in 2020. The increase may be attributed to the improvements and re-opening of the region's economy by lifting the local travel bans and community quarantines which allows visitors to travel in the NCR. Moreover, Metro Manila is home to different urban attractions, such as museums, historical sites and cultural heritage, shopping centers or malls, and food and accommodation establishments, which play a pivotal role in the region's tourism industry.

The region also boasts a number of accommodation establishments which consist of hotels, apartment hotels, Mabuhay accommodations, and resorts. These establishments can provide services to millions of visitors while strictly observing the implementation of health guidelines and protocols.

Table 10. Visitor Arrivals in NCR, 2020-2021

VISITORS	2020	2021
Same day Visitors	**716,350**	**2,419,415**
Foreign visitors	390	3,503
Local Visitors	779,373	2,415,912
Overseas Visitors	-	-
Overnight Visitors	**1,637,815**	**2,201,903**
Foreign visitors	407,438	180, 318
Local Visitors	1,184,459	1,885,293
Overseas Visitors	45,918	136,292

Source: Department of Tourism - National Capital Region
Note: Data submissions mainly came from selected cities of the region (City of Makati, City of Parañaque, City of Manila, City of Muntinlupa, Pasay City, Quezon City, City of Pasig, City of Mandaluyong, and City of Valenzuela.

03

Challenges and Prospects

Inflation

The increasing prices of crude oil in the local and international markets may persist due to global economic circumstances that affect the supply of oil. It may eventually lead to higher transportation fares for all public transport vehicles in the country to allow the operators to cover the cost of their operations. In mitigating the effect and impact of the transport fare hike to the people, the extension of the Libreng Sakay Program of the Department of Transport may play a crucial role.

Likewise, the prices for alcoholic beverages and tobacco will continue to rise due to the implementation of Republic Act 11467, which amends and adds to the National Internal Revenue Code of 1997. This increases the excise taxes charged to the mentioned commodities.

In regard to the financial services, a downgrading trend in its inflation rate may be expected as the Bangko Sentral ng Pilipinas continues to implement relief measures and policies to ease the aggressive increase in the credit interest rates. This will also allow lenders to accommodate more micro, small, and medium enterprises (MSMEs) and other personal loans as the country's economy recovers from the effect of the pandemic.

Business Establishments

A positive outlook for the business sector in the NCR is projected as the region reopened its borders for less restricted economic activities and allowed more businesses to operate despite the ongoing health crisis. Through the programs and policies implemented by the government and LGUs to support and aid the operations of business establishments, especially MSMEs, the sector is expected to recover from the losses it experienced from the previous year. The tax exemptions enacted to support and ease the burden of operating businesses may also pave the way for the sector to flourish.

Moreover, the establishment of more Negosyo Centers in the region will also play a pivotal role in bringing the government programs closer to the MSMEs, such as financial or credit support programs, capacity-building activities, training and seminar, and access to market. Other programs that will promote upgrading and innovation to capacitate the MSMEs, such as the Department of Science and Technology (DOST) assisted programs, may also help in encouraging the businesses to engage in the local market at the national level and may boost the number of business establishments in the region.

Employment

The employment sector of the region showed positive growth as the business establishments in the NCR were allowed to operate with more workers. However, the region's employment rate is still lower than its pre-pandemic level and its unemployment rate is higher than the 2019 reported data. Hence, the nationwide rollout of the COVID-19 vaccination programs to protect essential workers against the virus, and the issuance of the safety seal certificates to establishments may help in boosting the confidence of both employers and employees to operate in the region.

Moreover, improving the competitiveness of Metro Manila in this time of crisis in terms of economic aspects, government efficiency, infrastructure, resiliency, and innovation may encourage more investments which will create more business establishments and provide more stable jobs for the region.

Tourism

The increasing and recurring surge of COVID-19 cases in the region in 2021, as it reopened its economy, resulted in the imposition of mobility restrictions and local travel bans in some cities in Metro Manila to control the spread of the virus. This put more pressure on its tourism sector, causing uncertainties with regard to the safety of traveling in the region and further lowering the confidence of the locals and foreigners to stay or travel within the NCR.

Some of the foreseen drivers to improve the tourism industry and boost the number of visitors in the region are the development of new tourism circuits within the region and in between other regions near NCR, and promoting Metro Manila as a safe place for Meetings, Incentives, Conferences and, Exhibitions (MICE) destination. Furthermore, in 2021, the Department of Tourism-NCR participated in the travel exchange with other DOT-accredited tour operators in other regions to promote tourist destinations in the NCR and attract more visitors. An update on the tourism industry products such as the Urban Attraction tourism industry was also conducted to highlight the museums, historical sites, shopping centers, theaters, among others that can be found in Metro Manila.

A more comprehensive plan for the tourism industry in the region may also create more opportunities for the sector to flourish. To achieve this, accurate, reliable, and credible data gathered from the LGUs will play a pivotal role.

The accreditation and awarding of safety seals to the accommodation and food establishments will also play a crucial role in increasing and attracting local and international tourists as it serves as a security measure to ensure the safety and compliance of the establishments to the health guidelines and protocols imposed by the government. This will build the confidence of the tourists to travel and visit the destinations in the NCR, and will contribute to the recovery of the accommodation and food service industry.

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